Gloryhammer

Secrets beneath Auchtertool

HOMEBREW

The Gloryhammer "One Shot" - Secrets beneath Auchtertool

M4RZ Crafting

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Introduction

Beneath the whirring workshops and crowded streets of Auchtertool, something ancient has been disturbed. Where artificers labour to forge machines for the coming war, a forgotten passage has opened beneath the city - one that predates its engines, its constructs, and perhaps much of the Kingdom of Fife itself. Now, a company of mechanical specialists must descend where no machine of Auchtertool has ventured before and uncover the secrets buried in the darkness below.

Campaign Context

"Secrets Beneath Auchtertool" takes place shortly after the Questlords of Inverness defeated the Dread-Witch Queen of Cellardyke. In gratitude for their aid, the Mecha-King and the Robot Prince of Auchtertool pledged their allegiance to the Kingdom of Fife, promising the might of Auchtertool for the coming final battle against Zargothrax.

With war drawing ever closer, the city's artificers have begun preparing their inventions and constructs for the conflict ahead. During the testing of new weapons of war an experimental ballista strikes the central plaza of Auchtertool. While repairing the damage around the great fountain, workers uncover something entirely unexpected: an entrance leading beneath the city.

A team of specialized constructs is assembled to investigate and excavate the newly uncovered passage. What begins as a straightforward expedition soon leads them far beneath Auchtertool, where forgotten ruins, mysterious technologies, and secrets buried since the old days await.

Adventure Overview

Session Length: 3-4 hours
Party Size: 3-5 characters
Party Level: 5th level
Character Creation: Pregenerated characters recommended

Encounters throughout this adventure are designed primarily for a party of 3-5 5th-level characters and may require adjustment for groups outside this range.

"Secrets Beneath Auchtertool" is a short, exploration-focused adventure in which the players take control of a team of specialized constructs assembled for an expedition beneath the city. The provided characters represent different classes and functions within the expedition, allowing the players to experience a variety of playstyles. Custom characters can be used at the DM's discretion, though this is discouraged, as integrating individual backgrounds may prove difficult without revealing elements of the adventure beforehand.

The expedition begins after a weapons test in preparation for the coming war goes spectacularly awry. An experimental ballista damages part of Auchtertool's central plaza, and the subsequent repairs uncover a sealed passage beneath the great fountain. With neither its origin nor its destination known, the constructs are sent below to investigate what has lain forgotten beneath Auchtertool.

The adventure focuses primarily on exploration, environmental challenges, and puzzles as the expedition descends into an ancient dwarven complex. The deeper the constructs venture, however, the more their discoveries begin to challenge the established history of Fife. Advanced machinery lies dormant beneath the earth, while gnomish runes and architectural elements intermingle with dwarven craftsmanship, suggesting a connection between the two peoples during the old days that has long since been forgotten.

Although exploration and discovery form the heart of the adventure, the expedition ultimately culminates in a combat encounter, allowing the players to put the distinct capabilities of their characters to use.

Adventure Background

Long before the modern Kingdom of Fife arose, dwarven settlements stretched beneath much of the land. Vast subterranean roads connected several great strongholds, allowing goods, knowledge, and travellers to move between distant parts of the dwarven realms without ever setting foot beneath the open sky. Although many smaller settlements existed throughout this network, three great centres became renowned for their individual crafts: Methven for alchemy, Aberdeen for smithwork and metallurgy, and Aberdour for constructs, weaponry, and experimental sources of energy.

Over time, however, relations between these settlements deteriorated. Their different traditions grew increasingly insular, and cooperation gave way to rivalry and distrust. Aberdour became particularly controversial among the other dwarven realms. Its engineers had begun constructing increasingly sophisticated mechanical servants, initially little more than simple labourers before gradually developing constructs capable of exploration, complex craftsmanship, and eventually warfare.

Seeking to push their inventions still further, the dwarves of Aberdour invited gnomish tinkers and engineers to live and work alongside them. Their aptitude for intricate mechanisms proved invaluable, and dwarven engineering soon began to incorporate gnomish ideas, symbols, and methods. To the other dwarven settlements, however, this cooperation represented an unacceptable breach of tradition. Outsiders had not merely been welcomed into Aberdour—they had been permitted to share in knowledge once guarded closely by the dwarves.

Whatever remained of the old unity was eventually shattered during the Great Eagle War between Angus and Fyfdonia. Tremors and devastation from the conflict collapsed great stretches of the subterranean network, while other passages were destroyed entirely. With its principal routes severed, the underground kingdom of Aberdour became completely isolated.

In the centuries that followed, even knowledge of its

existence faded. Only scattered remnants of its technology survived close enough to the surface to be rediscovered. These vestiges would eventually contribute to the rise of modern Auchtertool and its extraordinary mechanical traditions, though their true origin was long forgotten.

The Citadel of Aberdour

The passage uncovered beneath Auchtertool's central plaza is not itself part of the lost city. Instead, it is one surviving branch of the ancient transportation network that once connected Aberdour with the other dwarven settlements beneath Fife.

Far beyond the newly opened entrance lies the Citadel of Aberdour, an immense subterranean complex that once stood at the centre of the kingdom's technological development. Within its workshops and laboratories, dwarven and gnomish engineers experimented with constructs, weapons, machinery, and forms of energy far beyond anything preserved in modern histories.

Most of the connecting passages have collapsed over the centuries, leaving the citadel effectively sealed away. The route discovered beneath Auchtertool is one of the rare surviving approaches.

Importantly, opening the passage beneath the plaza does not awaken the citadel or reactivate its defences. The newly exposed entrance is merely part of a dormant transportation route. Only once the expedition reaches the deeper reaches of Aberdour will the ancient mechanisms and guardians that remain within become relevant.

The Energy Cores

Much of Aberdour was once powered by enormous devices known only to modern observers as energy cores. Several remain embedded throughout the citadel, though most are inaccessible, inseparable from the machinery they power, or located far beyond the areas explored during this adventure.

The core discovered by the expedition is different.

It lies within what appears to have once been an engineering or assembly chamber and seems never to have been fully completed. Its outer structure remains unfinished, several components have yet to be properly integrated, and the device lacks whatever final refinements were required to make it fully operational. Nevertheless, its construction suggests a level of technological sophistication far beyond anything currently produced in Auchtertool.

Ancient guardian constructs still protect the chamber in which it rests. Whether they were assigned specifically to safeguard the unfinished core or simply to defend the workshop and its contents has long since been forgotten.

Recovering the device is possible, but completing or activating it is beyond the scope of this adventure. Whatever potential lies within the core will require considerably more study before it can be put to use.

Ralathor-38B

Unknown to nearly everyone in this timeline, Ralathor-38B originates from another reality and has travelled across both time and the multiverse. The circumstances of his arrival and the means by which he accomplished this are not relevant to this adventure. To those who encounter him, he is known simply as the Mysterious Hermit.

Ralathor has come to this timeline for one purpose: to aid in the eventual defeat of Zargothrax. His knowledge of the forgotten dwarven tunnel network is central to that goal. Somewhere within those ancient passages lies a covert route into Dundee, one that Zargothrax himself does not know exists. Ralathor intends to reveal this route to Prince Angus McFife and the Questlords of Inverness when the proper moment arrives.

Running the Adventure

The following guidance is intended to help the DM keep Secrets Beneath Auchtertool focused, flexible, and suitable for a single-session format. While the adventure follows a clear progression, individual scenes can be shortened, expanded, or adjusted depending on the pace and size of the group.

Adventure Structure

"Secrets Beneath Auchtertool" follows a largely linear progression: the constructs receive their briefing in Auchtertool, descend into the ancient transportation tunnels, and encounter the mysterious Ralathor-38B somewhere along the forgotten route. Continuing onward, they eventually reach the lost Citadel of Aberdour, explore its abandoned halls, and discover the unfinished energy core. The expedition culminates in a final combat encounter before the surviving constructs return to Auchtertool with their discovery.

Pacing & Exploration

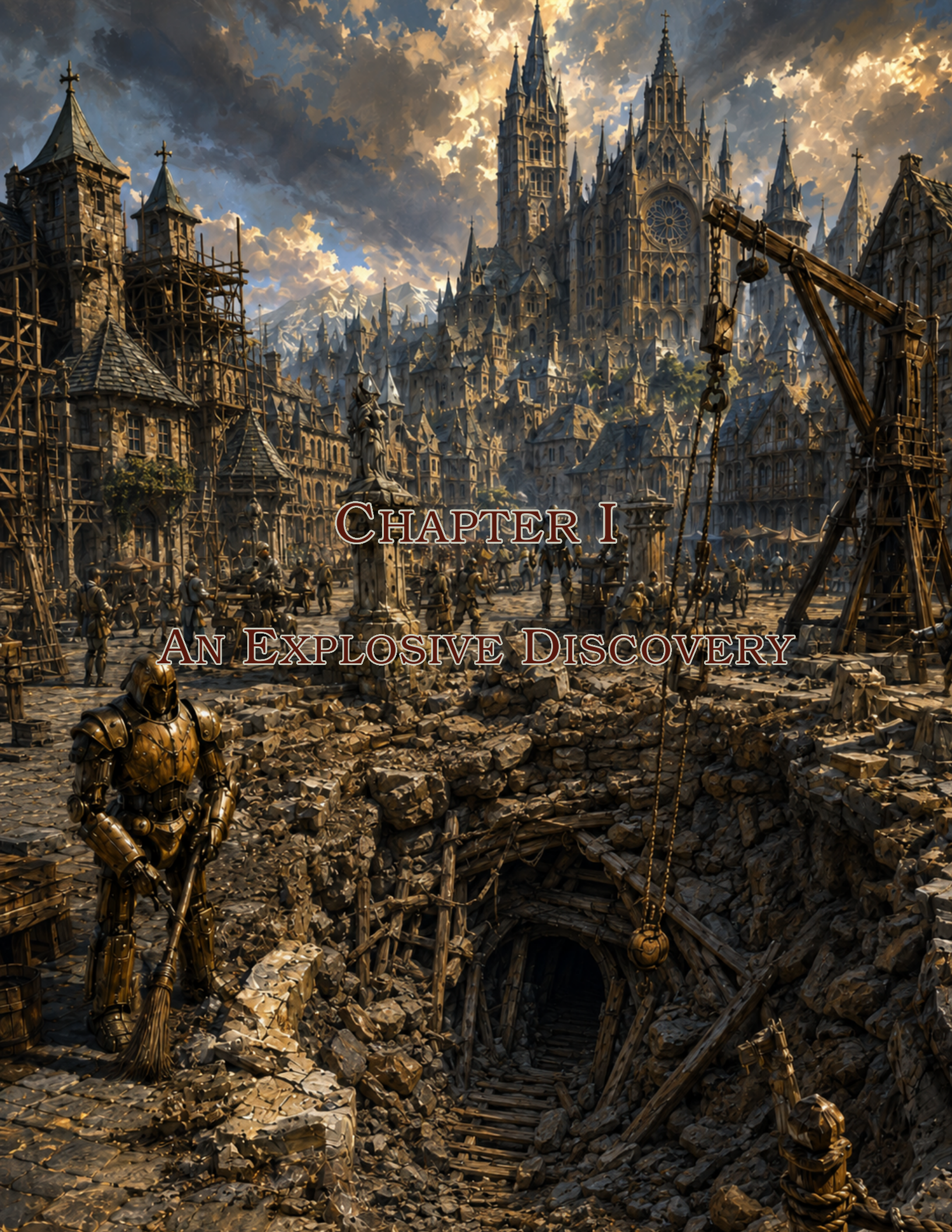
The adventure is intended to fit within a single session of approximately 3-4 hours. Exploration and puzzles form the majority of play, but not every minor discovery is required to complete the adventure. Optional rooms, historical details, and secondary challenges may be shortened or omitted if additional time is needed for the later sections.

Important discoveries should never depend upon a single successful ability check. Failed checks should instead introduce complications, hazards, or alternative routes while allowing the expedition to continue.

Characters & Encounters

The pregenerated constructs are already members of the expedition and require no additional motivation to work together. Players should simply select their characters before the opening briefing.

Encounters are primarily designed around 3-5 5th-level characters. The DM should adjust the number or strength of hostile creatures where necessary, particularly during the final combat encounter, to account for unusually small or large groups.



Chapter I

An Explosive Discovery

The Ruined Plaza

Four days ago, the testing of a new heavy ballista ended in an unexpected strike against Auchtertool's central plaza when its experimental alignment and automatic target-acquisition systems malfunctioned. The impact shattered much of the old fountain and tore through the surrounding pavement.

During clean-up and repair work two days later, workers discovered that the destruction had exposed a much older structure beneath the plaza. Further excavation revealed part of a broad underground passage, prompting all work to be suspended until a specialized expedition could investigate. Since then, crude wooden steps and supports have been fitted into the opening to allow access below.

Most traces of the accident have already been cleared away, though cracked paving stones and hastily patched masonry still scar the central plaza. Where the fountain once stood yawns a broad, uneven hole surrounded by broken stone and exposed earth.

Rough wooden steps descend through the rubble toward an ancient passage below. Beyond them, dark-gray masonry stretches into the earth, its precisely fitted stones and faint geometric markings starkly different from the foundations of Auchtertool above.

Artificers, labour constructs, and curious onlookers watch from a cautious distance, none apparently eager to approach the edge.

Today, that changes.

Expedition Briefing

With the entrance secured and preliminary excavation complete, the Artificer Guild has assembled a small team of specialized constructs to conduct the first proper expedition below Auchtertool. No one has travelled farther than the exposed section immediately beneath the plaza, and little is known about the age, extent, or original purpose of the passage.

The expedition has deliberately been composed of units suited to excavation, reconnaissance, security, maintenance, infiltration, and arcane analysis. Their task is not merely to explore, but to determine whether the discovery presents a danger to Auchtertool and whether anything beneath the city might prove useful in the coming war.

A soot-stained artificer stands near the edge of the excavation, clutching a clipboard beneath one arm while several measuring devices tick and whir around him.

"Right. The good news is that we have discovered something beneath Auchtertool. The less good news is that we have absolutely no idea what it is."

He gestures toward the darkness below.

"You are the first expedition. Find out where that passage leads, determine whether anything down there intends to kill us, and document anything unusual along the way. Machinery, inscriptions, artefacts, structural oddities - if it looks important, record it."

His eyes briefly wander toward the ruined fountain.

Mission Briefing

Expedition Directives

Primary Objective.
Explore the newly uncovered passage and determine its extent and destination.

Secondary Objective.
Document any structures, inscriptions, machinery, or artefacts of historical or technological significance.

Security Directive.
Identify and contain any threat the passage may pose to Auchtertool.

Recovery Directive.
Recover useful material where doing so does not jeopardize the expedition or the structure.

1 Uncovered Passage

The makeshift stairs descend only a short distance before reaching the structure uncovered beneath the plaza. The passage continues far beyond the small entry tunnel into darkness.

Before you stretches a broad underground passage, far wider than any mine shaft or service tunnel. Its floor has been worn into shallow parallel grooves, while evenly spaced alcoves and faded markings line the walls. Broken carts of dark wood and rusted iron stand abandoned along the route, some still filled with stone, timber, or corroded containers.

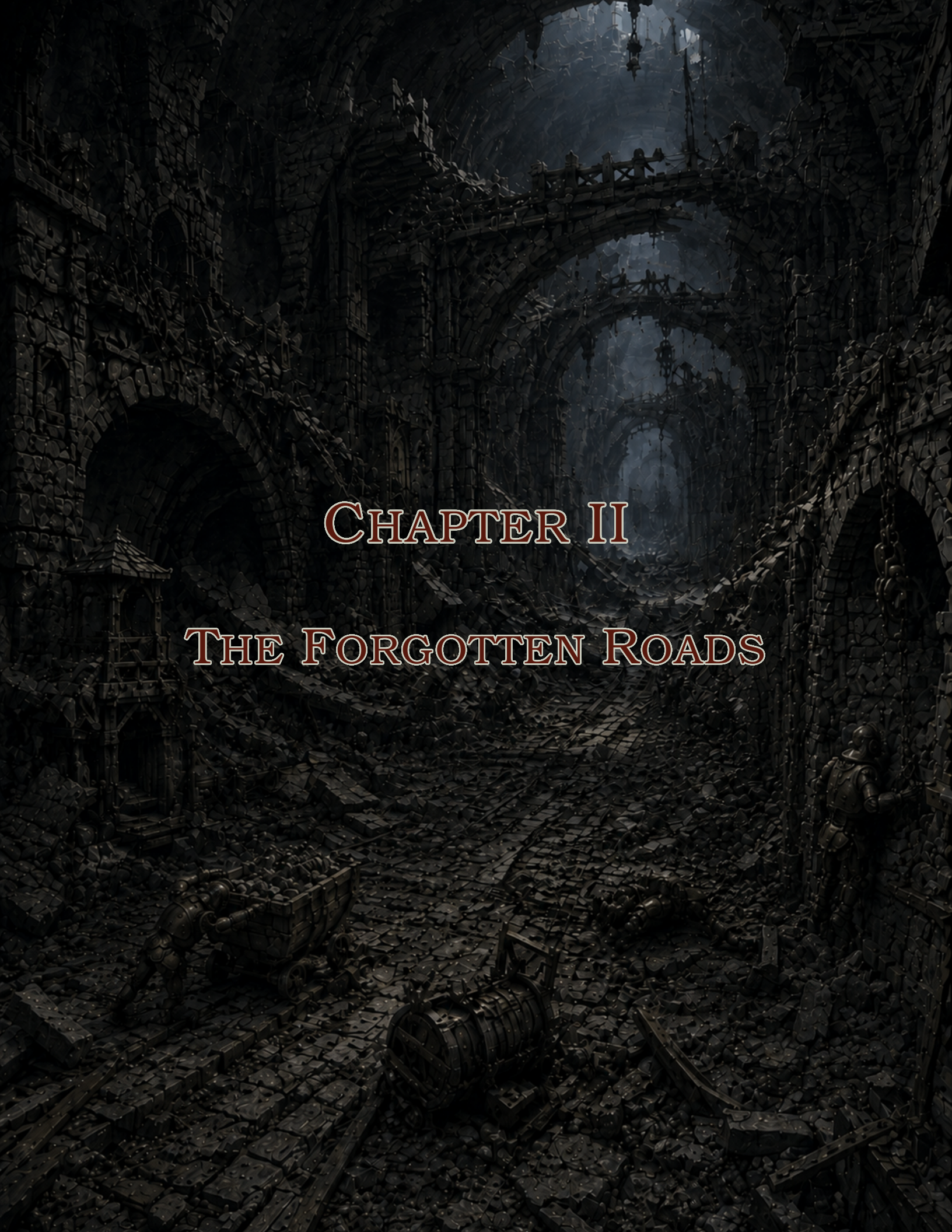
And some are not entirely abandoned.

A squat automaton strains endlessly against the rear of one cart whose wheels have long since collapsed beneath it. Farther ahead, another marches steadily into a wall, pauses, turns slightly, and resumes marching into the same wall once more.

Examining the Passage

A character may spend a moment to inspect their surroundings:

- ***DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation):*** *The grooves in the floor were formed by countless cart wheels following roughly the same paths rather than by any fixed rail system.*
- ***DC 10 Intelligence (History):*** *The stonework is much older than Auchtertool and resembles ancient Dwarven construction, though its exact age is difficult to determine.*
- ***DC 12 Wisdom (Perception):*** *A weak but continuous airflow travels through the passage from somewhere far ahead, suggesting that the tunnel extends a considerable distance.*
- ***DC 12 Intelligence (Arcana):*** *Faint magical residue remains within some of the automatons and wall fixtures, but almost every active system is operating on little more than residual power.*



Chapter II

The Forgotten Roads

2 Collapsed Tunnel

Farther along the forgotten road, the damage caused by the ancient collapse becomes increasingly severe. Great fractures split the surrounding masonry until the expedition eventually reaches a section where the ceiling has given way entirely, burying the route beneath an enormous mass of stone, timber, and the remains of old cargo.

The passage ends abruptly beneath a mountain of debris. Broken blocks of masonry are wedged together with splintered beams, crushed carts, and centuries of accumulated dust, filling the tunnel from floor to ceiling.

Here and there, narrow gaps disappear through the rubble toward darkness on the other side. A faint current of air passes between the stones, but no opening appears large enough for most of you to follow.

Whatever road once continued beyond this point has been buried for centuries.

The collapse completely blocks the transport route. Although several narrow gaps extend through the rubble, none are large enough for most creatures to pass. Treat the mass of fallen stone and wreckage as the Ancient Debris described below.

Ancient Debris - Object

Armor Class *10*
Hit Points *140*
Damage Threshold *10*
Damage Vulnerabilities *Fire, Force*
Damage Immunities *Necrotic, Piercing, Poison, Psychic, Radiant, Slashing*

Two old Kegs of Alchemist's Fire remain on the far side of the collapse. One rests immediately beside the debris, while the second stands farther along the tunnel and must first be brought closer. Each keg normally deals 6d6 Fire damage, but the debris takes maximum damage from an exploding keg. Detonating both beside the collapse is sufficient to clear the debris completely.

The characters must determine for themselves how to ignite the kegs.

Clearing the Tunnel

The methods below describe several ways the expedition can clear the collapse using the characters' equipment and abilities. They are not exhaustive. Players should be encouraged to experiment with spells, tools, the surrounding environment, or their own solutions. Determine the resulting ***Clearance Time*** *based on how quickly and carefully their approach would overcome the obstruction.*

DM Annotation - Clearance Time

Record whether the party achieves **Rapid**, **Delayed**, or **Prolonged** Clearance. The time spent overcoming the collapse affects the state of the ancient constructs encountered at the Control Point farther along the route.

Conjured Constructs

Rapid Clearance

L.O.R.E.-3 can expend a 3rd-level spell slot to cast Conjure Constructs. The summoned constructs tear through the unstable obstruction with overwhelming efficiency, clearing the route almost immediately. The process is highly destructive, however, and anything fragile buried within the collapse is crushed or lost.

Drill and Alchemist's Fire

Delayed Clearance

B.R.E.A.C.H.-4 can use the Drill Arm to bore a narrow passage through the rubble. The opening is large enough for Small or smaller creatures to pass through, allowing B.R.E.A.C.H.-4 to reach the opposite side and move the second keg beside the collapse. If both kegs are subsequently detonated, the obstruction is destroyed.

The explosion leaves burning alchemical residue throughout the newly opened passage. The flames must be extinguished before the route can be crossed safely. Water, earth, appropriate magic, or any other reasonable method can put out the fire. A creature that moves through the burning passage without doing so takes 2d6 Fire damage.

Crawling Through the Cracks

Delayed Clearance

Silas's Threadborn construction allows him to compress his frame enough to squeeze through the narrow openings between the fallen stones. Once on the other side, he can reach both kegs, though he lacks the strength to move the more distant one unaided.

The party must devise another method of bringing the second keg toward the collapse or otherwise clearing the obstruction. Ropes, magic, improvised mechanisms, or assistance found farther along the passage may all provide possible solutions.

If Silas continues farther into the tunnels before the obstruction is cleared, treat his arrival at the next location as Rapid Clearance regardless of how long the remainder of the expedition ultimately takes.

Careful Tunnelling

Prolonged Clearance

B.R.E.A.C.H.-4 can instead use the Drill Arm for its intended purpose and gradually excavate a passage large enough for the entire expedition. This requires considerably more time but causes little additional damage to whatever has been buried within the collapse.

Breaking Through

Prolonged Clearance

The expedition can simply attack the debris until it is destroyed. Bludgeoning attacks, powerful magic, and other suitably destructive effects can gradually clear a path, though the debris' Damage Threshold and immunities make some methods considerably less effective than others. Fragile objects buried within the rubble may be damaged or destroyed during the process.

Buried Among the Rubble

The collapse contains the remains of cargo, tools, and personal belongings that were buried when the tunnel gave way centuries ago. How much survives depends largely on how the expedition clears the obstruction.

Rapid Clearance. *Nothing useful survives the process.*

Delayed Clearance. *Roll once on the Random Finds table.*

Prolonged, Careful Excavation. *Roll three times on the Random Finds table.*

Prolonged, Destructive Clearance. *Roll once on the Random Finds table when the debris is reduced to half its Hit Points and once again when it is destroyed. Particularly fragile finds may be destroyed at the DM's discretion.*

Random Finds

d10	Find
1	A small pouch containing several worn Dwarven trade tokens, each stamped with a different workshop mark.
2	A cracked cargo seal bearing the faded emblem of an unknown merchant house.
3	A bundle of corroded but still serviceable precision tools wrapped in brittle cloth.
4	A delicate brass measuring instrument covered in markings that do not resemble the surrounding Dwarven script.
5	A finely made folding lens, remarkably clear despite its age and noticeably different in construction from the surrounding equipment.
6	A palm-sized articulated clockwork figurine. Its intricate workmanship appears unlike that of the ancient Dwarven automatons.
7	A reinforced container holding one intact flask of Alchemist's Fire.
8	A Greater Potion of Healing.
9	A Dwarven cargo tag bearing a second, much smaller inscription in an unfamiliar language.
10	A compact brass arcane component that still carries faint residual magic.

3 Control Point

Farther along the transport route, the expedition reaches an old inspection station built across the tunnel. Most of its machinery has long since gone dark, but two ancient checkpoint constructs still remain at their posts. Their power reserves are nearly exhausted, yet both continue to perform duties that have been irrelevant for centuries.

As you approach, two figures slowly stir behind the abandoned checkpoint.

One straightens with a grinding of old joints while a dim amber light flickers behind its eyes. The other lifts its head from an ancient ledger, stares at you for several seconds, and quietly nudges its companion.

"Travellers."

"I see them."

"Actual travellers."

Another long pause follows.

"Credentials, Cargo Declaration and destination, please."

The constructs are cautious but far more curious than hostile. They have not encountered anyone new in centuries and quickly become fascinated by the expedition, particularly the unfamiliar construction of its members. Their original protocols require them to inspect travellers and cargo, but neither remembers those procedures particularly well.

Both are operating on extremely low power. Sentences occasionally trail off while systems temporarily shut down, movements occur several seconds after decisions are made, and arguments may be interrupted by long periods of complete silence. The larger Warden tries to remain professional and procedural, while the smaller Clerk is openly curious and frequently wastes precious power asking unnecessary questions.

The characters do not possess valid ancient credentials, but almost any plausible explanation, official document, clever argument, or sufficiently confident improvisation can eventually convince the pair to let them pass. Combat should only occur if the expedition deliberately attacks them.

A Matter of Time

What the characters overhear upon approaching depends on the Clearance Time recorded at the Collapsed Tunnel. If Silas reaches the checkpoint before the rest of the expedition, use Rapid Clearance.

Rapid Clearance - The Old Crane

The constructs are discussing an ancient irregularity that apparently happened so long ago neither can remember when. Someone repeatedly lingered around one of the nearby loading cranes without ever taking anything.

"Nobody visits the same crane that often without a reason."

"Perhaps they liked the crane."

"Nobody likes cranes that much."

Questioning them reveals little more, but the story provides a clue toward the Hidden Cache.

Delayed Clearance - Strange Noises

The constructs recently detected an unfamiliar sound farther along the transport route and are debating who should investigate.

"You should go."

"Power reserve: three percent."

"Mine is two."

A long silence follows.

"We should wait."

"Agreed."

Prolonged Clearance - Low Power

By the time the expedition arrives, both constructs have entered a reduced-power state. They still perform the basic inspection, but their responses are slow and minimal, and the expedition learns no additional information.

4 Hidden Cache

Behind one of the old loading cranes, several narrow passages once led into a concealed chamber. Centuries of shifting stone and accumulated debris have almost completely buried their entrances, leaving the wall seemingly solid at first glance.

Finding the Cache

The chamber can be discovered in several ways:

Stone Resonance. *B.A.S.A.L.T-S's Wardkeeper can be used to detect the hollow space beyond the wall and traces of narrow passages leading toward it.*

Detect Magic. *L.O.R.E-3 can detect faint magical signatures behind the masonry that do not belong to the surrounding tunnel infrastructure.*

Examining the Stonework. *S.C.O.U.T-1 can notice extremely old signs that the wall was once deliberately disturbed and excavated.*

Other reasonable methods may reveal the cache as well.

The original passages are clogged with rubble and only wide enough for Small or smaller creatures. They can be reopened by digging, drilling, or breaking through the surrounding stone.

Beyond the rubble lies a cramped chamber crowded with dusty shelves, sealed crates, engraved plates, and bundles of brittle notes.

There is little here that resembles treasure.

Whoever hid this place was concealing knowledge.

Stolen Research

The cache once belonged to an engineer who secretly removed research and prototype components from Aberdour, hiding them here rather than transporting them through the nearby checkpoint.

The recovered material includes advanced construct schematics, prototype actuators and arcane regulators, and incomplete plans for enormous operator-controlled machines intended for excavation, siege work, and hazardous environments.

If returned to Auchtertool, the recovered research can significantly aid its artificers in constructing and improving the machines prepared for the coming war.

5 Doors to Aberdour

The ancient transport road continues until it reaches a broad junction carved into the surrounding rock. The main tunnel carries on straight ahead, while a second route branches sharply to the right toward a monumental gateway.

The passage widens into a great junction.

Straight ahead, the old transport road continues into darkness, its course eventually broken by the jagged remains of a collapsed bridge spanning a vast chasm.

To your right, another route rises toward an enormous metal gate set into the surrounding stone. Its surface is covered in weathered geometric engravings and ancient Dwarven script.

5A Dwarven Door

The route ends before a massive gate forged from a single expanse of dark, ancient metal. Rows of Dwarven runes cover its surface, though many have faded almost beyond recognition.

A squat stone pedestal stands several feet before the door. Several differently shaped metal inlets surround a shallow central bowl, suggesting that the mechanism was intended to be operated from here.

The passage terminates before an immense metal door set deep into the surrounding rock. Its dark surface is covered in rows of weathered Dwarven runes, some still sharply engraved, others reduced to little more than faded scars.

Before it stands a broad stone pedestal. A shallow bowl occupies its centre, surrounded by several metal-lined recesses of different colours and finishes.

Whatever mechanism once opened the gate appears to remain intact.

Opening the Door

The door is sealed by an ancient Dwarven locking mechanism operated through the pedestal. Opening it requires the characters to correctly interact with the objects and inlets arranged upon it.

The exact puzzle can be replaced with another suitable challenge if desired. One possible implementation, ***A Dwarf Knows His Craft****, is described in the Resources Chapter at the end of this document.*

5B Meeting Ralathor

Beyond the Dwarven gate, the passage continues only a short distance before ending at a second sealed entrance. Unlike the first, this door is covered in far more intricate mechanisms, delicate fittings, and unfamiliar geometric patterns.

The passage beyond the first gate is quiet, disturbed only by the faint clicking of old machinery and the low murmur of a voice ahead.

A solitary man stands before the second door, leaning close to its surface as he studies one of the many interlocking mechanisms set into it.

"No... that cannot be right."

He adjusts something, waits, and receives no response.

Only then does he notice your approach.

He straightens slowly and looks between you, the open Dwarven gate behind you, and the constructs standing before him.

"Interesting", he says. "You are certainly not who I expected to find down here."

Ralathor introduces himself only as a mysterious hermit travelling through the ancient tunnels. He is cautious but curious, and quickly begins asking the expedition about the world above.

His knowledge of the tunnels is incomplete. Ralathor knows that the ancient Dwarves constructed an extensive subterranean network beneath much of the Kingdom of Fife,

and he suspects that similar passages may extend throughout other parts of Caledonia. He does not know where every route leads or what settlements may once have existed along them.

The door before him is particularly puzzling. Its mechanisms are far more intricate than the Dwarven engineering he expected to encounter within the tunnels, and its construction appears fundamentally different from the gate the party has just opened. Ralathor cannot explain who built it or why.

A Sudden Change in Priorities

Ralathor initially questions the expedition out of curiosity: where they came from, what brought them into the tunnels, and what is happening in the world above.

Once he learns of Zargothrax, the fall of Dundee, and the coming war, his demeanour changes immediately. His attention shifts away from the door and toward the route behind the party. He begins asking much more practical questions:

- *"You came from Auchtertool?"*
- *"How far?"*
- *"And Prince Angus - where is he now?"*

Ralathor quickly becomes preoccupied with determining the fastest route back to the surface and how he might reach Prince Angus McFife. He gives no clear explanation for his urgency, only insisting that he needs to speak with the prince as soon as possible.

5C Gnomish Door

The second gate bears little resemblance to the monumental Dwarven door behind the expedition. Its surface is covered in fine metalwork, recessed panels, rotating fittings, and several small mechanisms whose purposes are not immediately apparent.

The passage ends before another sealed door, but this one is unlike anything you have seen in the tunnels so far.

Brass fittings, narrow grooves, small dials, and interlocking mechanisms cover much of its surface. Several components appear movable, while others vanish into the stonework around the frame.

Nothing about it suggests a simple lock.

An example puzzle used to open the door is described in Resources: ***What Makes it Tick?***

Ralathor's Help

Ralathor has already spent some time examining the door before the expedition arrives. Although he has not discovered its solution, he has identified several properties of the mechanism and can provide hints if the players become stuck.

These hints should reveal how individual parts of the puzzle behave rather than provide the final solution. Once the door opens, Ralathor leaves the expedition behind and heads back toward Auchtertool, intent on reaching Prince Angus McFife as quickly as possible.

Hidden Button

A character who thoroughly examines the door or surrounding stonework may discover a small concealed button among the mechanisms.

Pressing it causes a series of engraved numbers around the button to illuminate, beginning at 20 and counting steadily downward. Pressing the button again resets the count to 20. Where a zero would normally appear is instead a small skull-and-crossbones symbol.

If the countdown reaches the skull, the final symbol illuminates, a mechanism gives a quiet click-

and nothing happens.

6 Broken Span

A vast section of the surrounding rock has collapsed away, splitting the tunnel across a deep subterranean chasm. The bridge that once carried the road across it has fared little better.

The transport road ends abruptly at the shattered remains of a stone bridge.

Beyond its broken edge yawns a vast chasm, its walls disappearing into darkness far below. Fractured pillars and pieces of ancient masonry cling to the rock face, while the opposite half of the bridge still reaches out from the far side.

Between the two ends lies a wide stretch of empty air.

Somewhere far below, loose stones strike unseen surfaces before their echoes finally fade.

Crossing the Chasm

The gap between the surviving sections of bridge is approximately 30 feet wide. The remaining stonework is stable enough to support the expedition, though its broken edges offer little protection against a fall.

There is no single intended solution. Characters should be encouraged to use their individual abilities, equipment, spells, or the remaining bridge structure to devise a way across. Possible approaches include:

- ***B.A.S.A.L.T-5*** *Its limited flight allows it to cross the gap directly and potentially carry or assist lighter members of the expedition.*
- ***B.R.E.A.C.H-4*** *The Drill Arm can create secure anchor points in the surrounding stone for ropes or improvised lines.*
- ***F.I.X-2*** *Ropes, tools, and available bridge debris can be fashioned into a crude crossing or secured line.*
- ***L.O.R.E-3*** *Utility magic may allow individual characters or equipment to cross without relying on the remains of the bridge.*
- ***Silas*** *His light frame and agility make traversing ropes, narrow ledges, or improvised crossings considerably easier than for heavier constructs.*

Other reasonable solutions should work without requiring a specific combination of characters.

Chapter III

A Lost Kingdom

Beyond the ancient approaches, the transport route finally opens onto the outskirts of a vast subterranean settlement. Much of Aberdour lies dark and silent, but enough of its architecture remains intact to reveal what once stood here: broad streets, workshops, plazas, bridges spanning deep fissures, and, far beyond them, the looming silhouette of a fortified citadel.

> The tunnel opens suddenly, and the darkness ahead gives way to something far greater than another passage.
>
> An entire city stretches across the cavern before you.
>
> Stone buildings descend in tiers along the rock, connected by broad streets and immense bridges crossing black chasms. Silent workshops and market halls surround a great central plaza, while far beyond them rises a massive citadel of dark stone and metal.
>
> Only scattered remnants of ancient light still burn among the ruins.

7 Maker's Quarter

The road into Aberdour passes through a district once occupied by workshops, small foundries, and private workrooms. Unlike the industrial facilities of Auchtertool, these spaces feel surprisingly personal, filled with half-finished projects and tools left exactly where their owners abandoned them.

> Low workshops line the street ahead, their stone fronts broken by wide doors and shuttered windows. Inside, workbenches of different heights stand beneath racks of rusted tools, while unfinished mechanisms, articulated limbs, and tiny clockwork devices lie scattered beneath layers of dust.
>
> Some benches are broad and heavy, others narrow and unusually low, but all bear the marks of careful use.

Characters who explore the quarter find little of immediate value. Most components have deteriorated beyond use, though intact precision tools, clockwork toys, and other small curiosities may still be recovered.

8 The Exchange

The streets widen into an open loading district built around broad platforms, storage bays, and old cargo lifts. This was once one of Aberdour's main transfer points, where goods arriving through the underground network were sorted before being moved deeper into the settlement.

> Broad stone platforms line the road ahead, bordered by loading ramps, shuttered storerooms, and ancient cranes.
>
> Broken carts stand where they were abandoned, some still bearing the remnants of sealed crates and trade markings. Rusted chains hang motionless from overhead gantries, while faded symbols mark different loading bays along the walls.
>
> Everything suggests a place once filled with noise, movement, and commerce.
>
> Now, only dust moves through the Exchange.

Characters who explore the area can find old cargo seals, trade tokens, damaged manifests, packing tools, and remnants of imported goods. Most material is worthless after centuries of decay, but the surviving markings show that Aberdour once received regular shipments from elsewhere in the underground network.

9 Great Plaza

The streets of Aberdour eventually open onto a vast central plaza before the citadel. Broad terraces, cracked statues, and weathered monuments surround the open space, while several ancient roads converge here from the surrounding districts.

> The ruins fall away into an immense stone plaza, its once-polished surface fractured by centuries of neglect.
>
> At its far end rises the dark bulk of the citadel, overlooking the city from behind monumental walls and sealed gates.
>
> Along one side of the plaza stands a broad relief carved into the rock. Most of its figures have been worn smooth, but Dwarven warriors, artisans, and scholars can still be distinguished among the faded shapes.
>
> Beneath them, a second, much smaller line of writing has been added in a noticeably different hand.

Ancient Relief

A broad stone relief dominates one side of the plaza. Its carvings depict the founding and growth of Aberdour: workshops filled with intricate machinery, constructs assisting their creators, and great engines drawing power through the settlement.

Two separate texts accompany the relief. One is written in Dwarvish, the other in Gnomish. Though their wording differs slightly, both describe the same purpose for Aberdour: the pursuit of knowledge, creation, and new means of harnessing power through the combined craft of its inhabitants.

Both passages conclude with a sentence that translates naturally as:

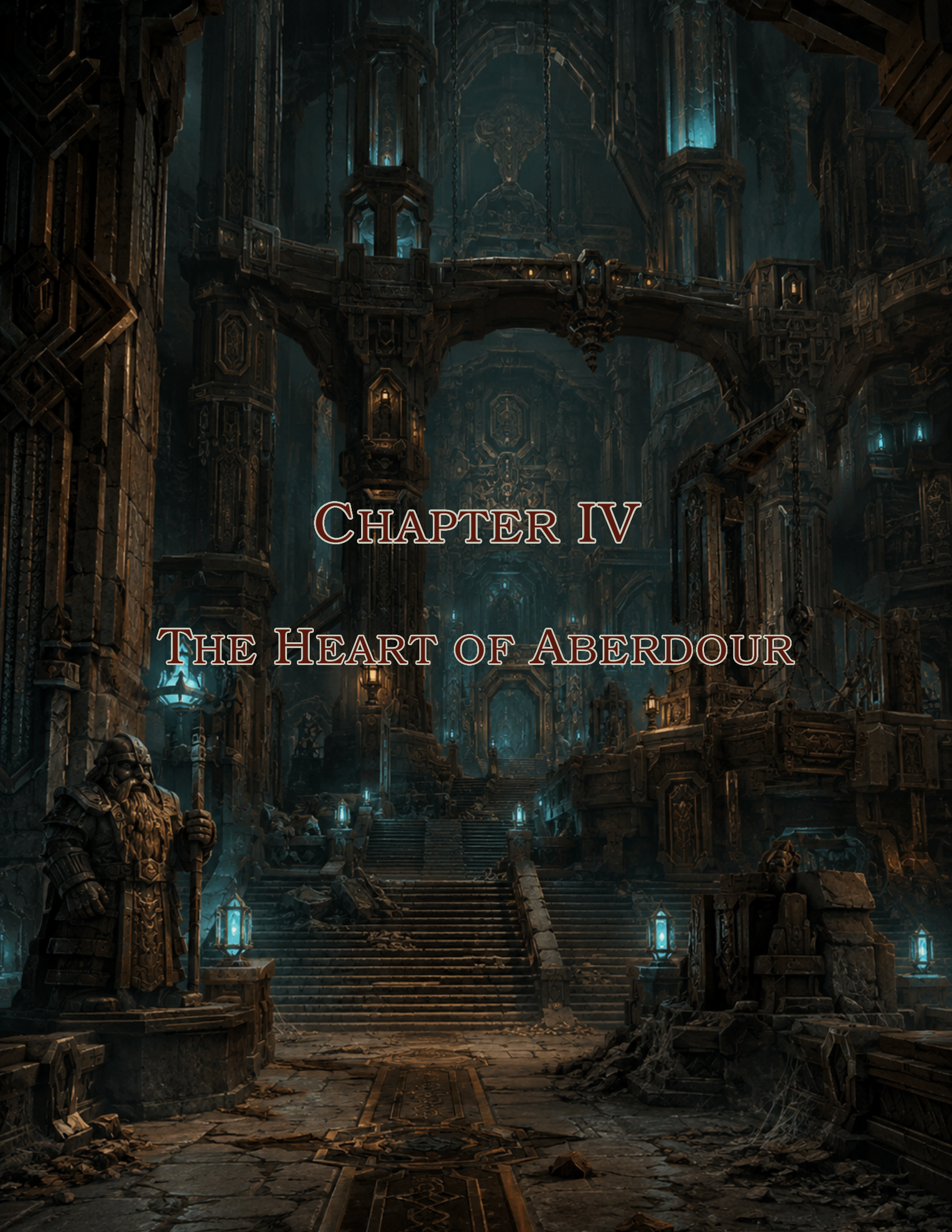
> "The mind is the greatest source of power."

The apparent agreement hides an important distinction.

Dwarvish Interpretation. *The word translated as mind carries the meaning of spirit, consciousness, or inner will. To the Dwarves, the phrase suggests that true power originates within the living spirit itself.*

Gnomish Interpretation. *The corresponding Gnomish word instead refers primarily to knowledge, intellect, or understanding. To the Gnomes, the phrase suggests that power comes from what can be learned, understood, and applied.*

A character familiar with either language can recognize these differing connotations. Magic such as ***Comprehend Languages*** *conveys the literal meaning of both passages, but the cultural distinction may require closer consideration.*



Chapter IV

The Heart of Aberdour

At the far end of the Great Plaza, broad steps ascend toward the ancient citadel of Aberdour. Even after centuries of abandonment, the structure dominates the settlement, its monumental walls built from dark stone reinforced with bands of metal. Almost every conduit and arcane fixture surrounding the entrance has gone dark, leaving only faint traces of power within the mechanisms beside the gates.

> The citadel rises above you, its immense gates sealed within a wall of dark stone and ancient metal.
>
> Faded runes, tarnished conduits, and dormant mechanisms spread across the entrance like the workings of some enormous machine. Most are lifeless, though here and there a weak pulse of light still travels through the stone before fading once more.
>
> The citadel is not entirely without power.
>
> Just very nearly.

10 Awake the Gate

With the entrance mechanism not receiving enough energy to operate on its own, the party must restore several damaged connection and redirect what little energy remains into the locking mechanism.

Resolve the restoration in three stages. Each stage can be approached in different ways, and reasonable uses of spells, tools, or character abilities should be rewarded. A failed check does not halt progress; instead, it introduces Instability into the damaged system.

Trace the Remaining Power

The characters must first determine which of the ancient conduits still carry energy. A character can attempt one of the following checks:

- ***DC 13 Intelligence (Arcana) Check** to follow the remaining magical current.*
- ***DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) Check** to reconstruct the original distribution network.*
- ***DC 14 Wisdom (Perception) Check** to identify faint pulses of light, heat, or vibration within active conduits.*

On a failure, the characters still locate the surviving circuit, but accidentally feed power into a dead section of the network. ***Gain 1 Instability.***

Reconnect the Conduits

Several connections along the surviving route have deteriorated beyond normal operation. They must be repaired or bypassed before energy can reach the gates. Possible approaches include:

- ***DC 14 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) Check** using Tinker's Tools to repair or bypass the damaged connections.*
- ***DC 14 Strength (Athletics) Check** to force a seized mechanical relay back into position.*

Appropriate spells or specialized equipment, such as Mending, may grant advantage or provide another suitable solution.

On a failure, the connections are restored imperfectly. ***Gain 1 Instability.***

Redirect the Flow

With the circuit restored, the remaining energy must be diverted away from the citadel's dormant systems and concentrated into the entrance mechanism. A character can attempt one of the following:

- ***DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) Check** to regulate the magical current directly.*
- ***DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) Check** to determine the correct sequence of regulators and switches.*
- ***DC 15 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) Check** using Tinker's Tools to manually recalibrate the distribution system.*

On a failure, the energy still reaches the gates, but the damaged network struggles to contain it. ***Gain 1 Instability.***

Instability

Once the final stage is completed, the gates open regardless of the accumulated Instability. The total instead determines how violently the ancient system reacts as power returns.

0 Instability - Clean Restoration

Energy flows steadily through the surviving conduits. Ancient locks disengage one after another and the gates open without incident.

1 Instability - Unstable Surge

Sparks erupt from several regulators as the gates open. Creatures working directly on the mechanism must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or take 1d6 Lightning damage.

2 Instability - System Overload

The restored circuit discharges violently. Creatures near the controls must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 2d6 Lightning damage on a failure or half as much on a success.

3 Instability - Emergency Discharge

The gates grind open as the entire entrance network overloads. Resolve the System Overload above, after which the restored conduits burn out completely and fall dark once more.

Within the Citadel

> Beyond the gates, the expedition enters a vast interior hall of dark stone and tarnished metal. Broad stairways rise toward elevated galleries while narrow bridges cross the open spaces between them. Most of the citadel remains without power, illuminated only by the occasional glow of a surviving conduit or rune.
>
> Several chambers branch from the main route, their doors standing partially open after centuries of neglect. Farther within, faint traces of energy continue deeper into the citadel.

The expedition can explore the chambers branching from the central hall before continuing deeper into the citadel. Prototype Assembly and Defence Cabinet are optional locations and may be omitted if time is running short. Neither is required to reach the Core Room, but both provide additional insight into Aberdour and its final years.

11 Prototype Assembly

A heavy metal door branches from the central hall, its surface marked with faded workshop sigils and several dormant warning runes. Unlike most of the citadel, a weak magical seal still clings to the entrance.

Opening the Door. *Normally, the door is held shut by a weak magical seal. It can be opened with a successful* ***DC 14 Intelligence (Arcana) Check*** *and* ***DC 14 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) Check*** *using Thieves' Tools to disrupt or bypass the remaining enchantment.*

If an ***Emergency Discharge*** *occurred while opening the citadel, the magical seal has already collapsed, but the ancient locking mechanism has seized completely. The door can then be forced open with a* ***DC 14 Strength (Athletics) Check****, repaired or bypassed with an appropriate Tinker's Tools check, or opened effortlessly with L.A.T.C.H's Ghostkey.*

Beyond the door lies a broad workshop crowded with stone benches, suspended frames, and the unfinished remains of ancient constructs.

Some are little more than articulated limbs and exposed mechanisms. Others resemble crude ancestors of the machines found throughout Auchtertool, their designs growing steadily more sophisticated from one workbench to the next.

Notes, diagrams, and engraved plates cover almost every available surface.

The surviving records concern experimental construct frames, power regulators, mobility systems, and numerous projects that were apparently never completed. Most are of historical rather than immediate practical value, but they reveal how rapidly construct design advanced within Aberdour.

On one stone desk lies a collection of notes written in Dwarvish. They record the unexplained disappearance of several precision tools, prototype components, and important blueprints. Repeated annotations suggest the loss was never resolved before the citadel was abandoned.

12 Defence Cabinet

A massive reinforced door seals one of the chambers branching from the central hall. Unlike the magically secured Prototype Assembly, no enchantment remains upon it - the problem is simply its weight. Centuries of neglect have left the hinges and locking bars almost completely seized.

Opening the Door. *A character can force the door open with a successful DC 17 Strength (Athletics) check. Suitable tools, leverage, or other creative methods may grant advantage or provide another means of entry.*

Beyond the heavy door lies a sombre strategic chamber. A broad stone table dominates its centre, surrounded by cabinets, map racks, and shelves filled with brittle records.

Most of the documents have been reduced to blackened scraps. Those that survive depict the Mines of Methven and the City of Aberdeen.

Whatever happened here, someone took considerable effort to ensure that much of this room's knowledge did not survive.

Military Records

Most of the strategic records have been deliberately burned. Whether this occurred during Aberdour's decline, as an act of sabotage, or as an attempt to keep sensitive information from falling into the wrong hands cannot be determined.

One partially preserved collection concerns a project referred to only as an ***"Ultimate Weapon of War"****. The records describe attempts to develop an entirely new form of power supply - an experimental energy core capable of sustaining something vastly more demanding than an ordinary construct.*

13 Core Room

Deeper within the citadel, the remaining traces of power converge upon a single chamber. Unlike the workshops and military rooms outside, this place feels almost ceremonial - a fusion of laboratory, archive, and sanctuary built around whatever rests at its centre.

Concentric rings of carved stone descend toward a deep well at its centre, surrounded by silent machinery and rows of weathered runes. Above the opening floats a small brass sphere, suspended within a thin stream of pale arcane energy rising from below.

Its surface is unfinished. Several plates remain open, delicate mechanisms exposed beneath them, while empty fittings suggest that parts of the device were never completed.

Yet even after centuries, the core still pulses faintly with power.

As you approach, a voice suddenly speaks - not from the chamber, but from somewhere within your own thoughts.

"Who are you? How did you find this place? And why have you come for my core? Answer me!"

The device suspended above the well is an unfinished energy core, one of the experimental power sources developed within Aberdour. Most of the surrounding equipment has long since failed, but a small amount of energy continues to sustain both the core and whatever presence remains connected to it.

King of Aberdour

The voice belongs to the last King of Aberdour, whose spirit has endured within the failing systems surrounding the unfinished core. Centuries of isolation have left him fiercely protective of what remains of his kingdom, and the sudden appearance of strangers within the Core Room is enough for him to assume the worst.

"Words."

A deep metallic groan echoes through the chamber.

"After all this time, strangers enter my kingdom and offer me words."

Across the chamber, an enormous construct slowly raises its head as pale light burns within its eyes. Two smaller stone guardians stir beside it.

"Show me what stands behind them."

The King takes control of the dormant ***Fellforged****, while two* ***Clockwork Defnders*** *activate alongside it.*

ROLL INITIATIVE!

Earning the King's Respect

Although combat begins immediately, the King continues speaking through the Fellforged and can be reasoned with during the battle. He is not interested in pleading or empty promises; demonstrations of strength, resolve, and purpose make him increasingly willing to listen.

A character may use a Bonus Action on its turn to address the King and attempt a ***Charisma (Persuasion) Check****. The initial DC is 18. Damaging the Fellforged proves that the expedition is more than a collection of scavengers. As the battle progresses, reduce the DC:*

- *Fellforged below 75% Hit Points: DC 16*
- *Fellforged below 50% Hit Points: DC 13*
- *Fellforged below 25% Hit Points: DC 9*

Particularly meaningful arguments may grant advantage. Examples include invoking the Dwarven interpretation of the relief in the Great Plaza, explaining why the constructs of Auchtertool willingly fight for Fife, describing the threat posed by Zargothrax, or demonstrating an intent to preserve rather than exploit Aberdour's legacy.

The characters require ***two successful Persuasion Checks*** *to convince the King. A character should accompany each check with an actual argument; repeatedly making the same appeal provides no further opportunity to persuade him.*

Defying the King

With the destruction of the vessel, other consciousnesses that had remained suppressed within it are revealed: the spirits of the Gnomish engineers who once worked alongside Aberdour's Dwarves.

Freed from the King's influence, they use their remaining knowledge to stabilize the unfinished device, completing it as the ***Knowledge Energy Core****.*

The King's Trial

If the characters earn two successes before destroying the Fellforged, the King abruptly halts the battle. The Fellforged lowers its weapons, and the Clockwork Stone Defenders return to their dormant positions.

> Enough.
>
> The enormous construct freezes.
>
> For several moments, only the fading hum of its machinery fills the chamber.
>
> "You possess strength. More importantly, you possess the will to decide what that strength is for."
>
> Somewhere deeper within the chamber, ancient locks begin to disengage.
>
> "But spirit is not proven by words and steel alone."

The King reveals one final test. An ancient ***Warforged Titan****, preserved within the Core Room for centuries, awakens to challenge the expedition.*

Defeating it proves the party worthy in the King's eyes. He willingly relinquishes himself to the unfinished core, allowing his spirit and determination to become the foundation upon which it completes itself.

The expedition receives the ***Spirit Energy Core****.*

Aftermath

With the core secured, the expedition retraces its path through the forgotten tunnels and eventually returns to the opening beneath Auchtertool's ruined fountain. The journey back can be summarized unless the DM wishes to revisit any unresolved location.

> When you finally climb through the opening beneath the plaza, the artificers waiting above immediately gather around.
>
> Their questions quickly fall silent when they see what you have brought back.
>
> What began as the accidental discovery of a forgotten passage has uncovered the remains of an entire lost kingdom - and technology Auchtertool could never have created alone.
>
> Before long, the recovered core and ancient research disappear into the city's workshops.
>
> There is a war coming, after all.

Effects on the Main Campaign

The discoveries made during Secrets Beneath Auchtertool influence the forces Auchtertool can later contribute to the war against Zargothrax.

Recovered Energy Core. *The type of core recovered determines the power source used for Auchtertool's great war construct.*

A Spirit Energy Core produces the more powerful version, empowered by the willing spirit of the last King of Aberdour.

A Knowledge Energy Core, completed through the surviving knowledge of Aberdour's Gnomish engineers, produces a less powerful but still formidable construct.

Hidden Cache Recovered. *If the expedition discovered the Hidden Cache, Auchtertool gains access to stolen Aberdour schematics, prototype components, and research into enormous operator-controlled machines. This significantly improves the final construct built for the coming war.*

Prototype Assembly Explored. *If the expedition investigated the Prototype Assembly, the artificers gain additional insight into Aberdour's experimental construct designs and the development of its ancient machines, providing a further improvement to Auchtertool's forces.*

Chapter V

Resources

A Dwarf Knows His Craft

A broad stone pedestal stands before the sealed gate. Five metal sockets are arranged around its edge, each fashioned from a different material: Iron, Copper, Silver, Bronze, and Gold. At its centre rests a shallow bowl containing five polished gemstones: a Diamond, Emerald, Sapphire, Amber, and Ruby.

Each gemstone must be placed into the socket the Dwarves considered its proper counterpart. Several inscriptions carved into the pedestal provide clues to the correct arrangement, though centuries of wear have left parts of them badly faded.

Around the central bowl reads:

> Stone has its character. Metal has its pride. Let each bear the jewel it deserves.

Running the Puzzle

Any gemstone fits into any of the five sockets. The mechanism remains dormant until all five sockets are occupied, allowing the characters to freely rearrange the gemstones before committing to an answer.

Once the final gemstone is placed, the pedestal evaluates the entire arrangement.

*If one or more gemstones are incorrect, the mechanism pauses for several seconds before ejecting all five gemstones back into the central bowl. Nearby runes briefly flare with a judgement such as **INCORRECT**. Repeated failures may instead produce increasingly condescending responses such as **STILL INCORRECT** or **APPRENTICE**.*

If every gemstone is correctly placed, the sockets lock them into position. The surrounding runes illuminate in sequence and heavy mechanisms begin turning within the gate.

Pedestal Inscriptions

The sides of the pedestal are carved with inscriptions:

Metal Socket	Inscription
Iron	*"Only that which yields to nothing is worthy of iron."*
Copper	*"Age clothes copper in green. Why should its jewel dress differently?"*
Silver	*"Silver belongs beneath the ... of night."*
Bronze	*"Bronze remembers the colour of the ancient ..."*
Gold	*"Gold requires no explanation."*

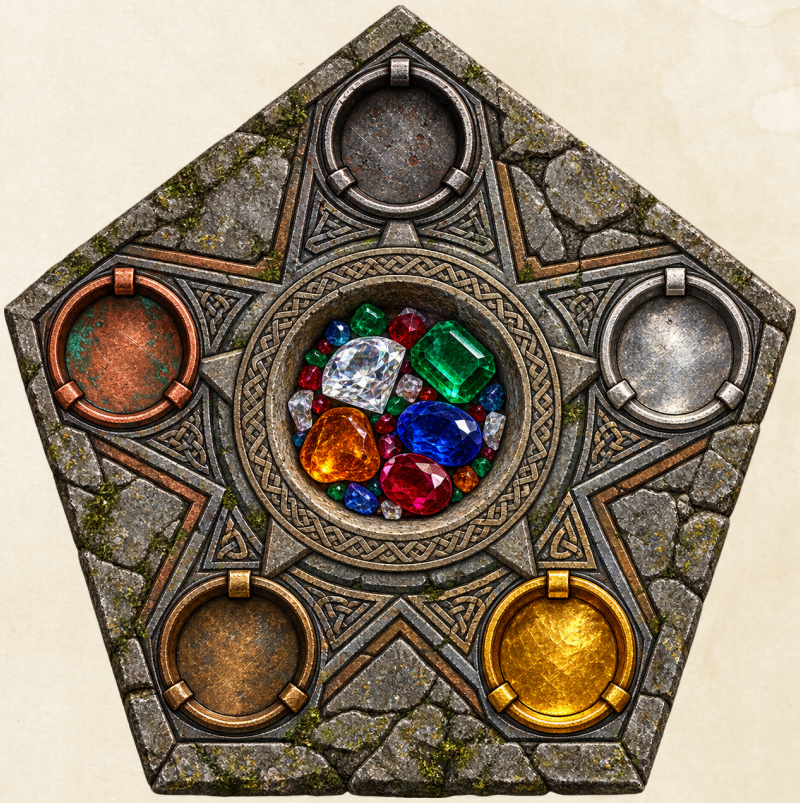
Faded Inscriptions. *The Silver inscription originally read "Silver belongs beneath the **cold light** of night", while the missing word in the Bronze inscription is "**sun**". A character who carefully examines the remaining markings may be able to reconstruct the faded text.*

DM Annotation - Solution

Iron - Diamond
Copper - Emerald
Silver - Sapphire
Bronze - Amber
Gold - Ruby

Physical Handout

The puzzle works particularly well as a physical handout. The pedestal can be printed separately from the five gemstone tokens, allowing the players to place the stones directly onto the corresponding metal inlets while solving the inscriptions.



What Makes it Tick?

Three circular mechanisms are set into the centre of the Gnomish Door. Each contains a rotating disk bearing three simple pictograms, while three additional symbols are engraved into the stationary ring surrounding it. The characters must rotate the disks until every pictogram is aligned with the object or device to which it properly belongs.

Unlike the Dwarven pedestal, however, none of the disks can be moved by hand. Three heavy levers beside the mechanism control them through an elaborate system of hidden gears. Pulling one lever always rotates several disks at once, forcing the characters to consider how each movement affects the rest of the mechanism.

An inscription beneath the controls reads:

> Every part has its purpose. Every purpose has its part.

Running the Puzzle

Each disk has three possible orientations. The nine rotating symbols must ultimately align with their corresponding fixed pictograms around the mechanism. The three levers operate as follows:

Lever I. *Rotates the Left Disk one step counter-clockwise and the Middle Disk one step clockwise.*
Lever II. *Rotates the Right Disk one step clockwise and the Middle Disk one step counter-clockwise.*
Lever III. *Rotates the Left and Right Disks one step counter-clockwise and the Middle Disk one step clockwise.*

The levers may be pulled any number of times and the mechanism cannot become permanently stuck. Because every possible orientation of the three disks can be reached, the puzzle is always solvable regardless of their starting positions.

Pulling a lever causes gears to grind somewhere behind the door before the affected disks click into their new positions. The mechanism provides no indication that an individual pairing is correct; only the complete arrangement is evaluated.

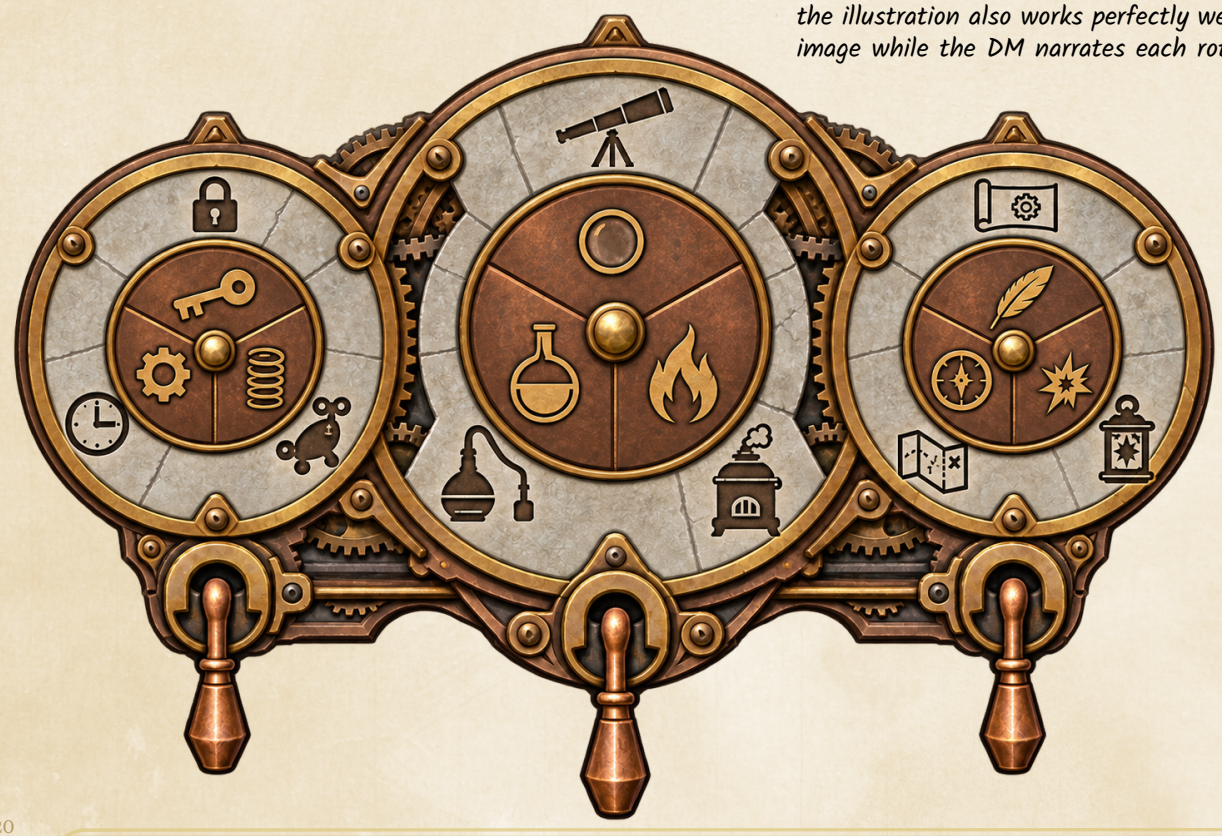
Once all nine symbols are aligned with their proper counterparts, the disks lock into place. A sequence of small lights travels across the mechanism, followed by a rapid series of metallic clicks as the locking system disengages and the Gnomish Door opens.

DM Annotation - Solution

Symbol I		Symbol II	Symbol I		Symbol II
Key	-	Lock	Cog	-	Clock
Spring	-	Wind-Up Toy	Lens	-	Telescope
Flask	-	Alembic	Flame	-	Boiler
Quill	-	Blueprint	Compass	-	Map
Spark	-	Arcane Lantern			

Physical Handout

At the table, a physical representation of the mechanism makes the linked rotations much easier to understand and allows the players to experiment with the three levers visually rather than having to track every movement through narration alone. If desired, the disks can even be made movable, though the illustration also works perfectly well as a simple reference image while the DM narrates each rotation.



Clockwork Defender

Medium Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class 16 **Initiative** +0 (10)
Hit Points 105 (14d8 + 42)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	10 (+0)	17 (+3)	3 (-4)	10 (+0)	1 (-5)

Damage Immunities Poison
Condition Immunities Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages Dwarvish
Challenge 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Magic Resistance. *The Clockwork has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.*

Construct Nature. *The Clockwork doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.*

Actions

Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) Bludgeoning damage, and if the target is Large or smaller, it is knocked Prone.*

Reactions

Intercept Attack. *Trigger: Another creature within 5 feet of the Clockwork is being hit by an attack roll.*
Response: That creature gets a +5 bonus to its AC against the triggering attack.

Fellforged

Medium Construct, Lawful Evil

Armor Class 15 **Initiative** +0 (10)
Hit Points 135 (18d8 + 54)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws STR +5, WIS +5
Damage Resistances Acid, Cold, Fire, Lightning
Damage Immunities Necrotic, Poison, Psychic
Condition Immunities Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 12
Languages Dwarvish, Gnomish
Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Construct Nature. *The Fellforged doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.*

Inhabiting Spirit. *The fellforged is inhabited and animated by a specter. If the fellforged fails a saving throw against an effect that turns undead, the specter is expelled into an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the fellforged with the HP Total it had before it was expelled. The specter otherwise uses the statistics of a specter.*

Without its animating specter, the fellforged becomes dormant for 1 minute then crumbles to pieces and is destroyed. The expelled specter can reinhabit the dormant fellforged as a bonus action while within 5 feet of the fellforged, making it active again and using the specter's current HP as the fellforged's HP Total.

Sunlight Sensitivity. *While in sunlight, the fellforged has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.*

Actions

Multiattack. *The fellforged makes two Necrotic Slam attacks.*

Necrotic Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) Bludgeoning damage plus 9 (2d8) Necrotic damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 14 Constitution Saving Throw or its HP Maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the necrotic damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its HP Maximum to 0.*

Bonus Actions

Burst Gears. *The specter within the fellforged strains the construct's body, sending broken springs and gears flying. Dexterity Saving Throw: DC 14, each creature within 5 feet of the Fellforged.*
Failure: 7 (2d6) Piercing damage.
Success: Half as much damage.

Each time the Fellforged uses this bonus action, its speed is reduced by 5 feet, and it can't use this bonus action if its speed is 0. Its speed returns to normal when it finishes a long rest.

Warforged Titan

Huge Construct, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 20 ***Initiative*** -1 (9)
Hit Points 125 (10d12 + 60)
Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
23 (+6)	8 (-1)	22 (+6)	3 (-4)	11 (+0)	1 (-5)

Damage Immunities Poison, Psychic
Condition Immunities Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages Dwarvish, Gnomish
Challenge 8 (3,900 XP) ***Proficiency Bonus*** +2

Actions

Multiattack. The warforged titan makes one axehand attack and one hammerfist attack.

Axehand. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 19 (3d8 + 6) Slashing damage plus 11 (2d10) Slashing damage if the target is Prone.

Hammerfist. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 19 (3d8 + 6) Bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Sweeping Axe (Recharge 6). The warforged titan makes a sweep with its axehand. Dexterity Saving Throw: DC 17, each creature within 10 feet of the Warforged.
Failure: 19 (3d8 + 6) Slashing damage.
Success: Half as much damage.

Big Thanks To These Artists

- Page 1 Art: *Secrets Beneath Auchtertool by ChatGPT*
- Page 5 Background Art: *Ruined Plaza of Auchtertool by ChatGPT*
- Page 7 Background Art: *Forgotten Roads of Aberdour by ChatGPT*
- Page 12 Background Art: *Dwarven City of Aberdour by ChatGPT*
- Page 14 Background Art: *Dwarven Citadel of Aberdour by ChatGPT*
- Back Cover Art: *Well of Energy and Spirits by ChatGPT*